Caleb Stauss

Product Designer, Systems Architect & AI Creative Technologist

DESIGN WITH ALTITUDE

479-202-1250 calebstauss@gmail.com stauss.io linkedin.com/in/calebstauss

Dear Hiring Team,

The most interesting product problems rarely arrive as clear requirements. Sometimes they begin as a half-formed idea with no obvious path forward; other times they are buried in the complexity of an established enterprise system. I enjoy both. Over fifteen years, I've worked across strategy, design, and engineering to turn those uncertain starting points into experiences people can understand, trust, and use.

I call my approach Design with Altitude. At the highest level, I look at the business opportunity, the people affected, and the risks worth solving. At the systems level, I connect workflows, data, constraints, and decisions into a coherent direction. On the ground, I prototype, design, and build to understand how an experience actually behaves. I move between those altitudes because a choice at one level changes what is possible at the others. That range helps me spot the underlying problem, explain trade-offs, and bring teams along rather than handing off a vision disconnected from reality.

AI is part of how I work, not a substitute for how I think. I direct LLMs, coding agents, and emerging tools to accelerate synthesis, explore alternatives, develop working prototypes, and pressure-test assumptions. The speed creates more room for judgment: asking better questions, validating with people, and deciding what deserves to ship. I stay close to the implementation while holding a high bar for interaction, typography, accessibility, and the small details that make a product feel considered.

What I would bring to your team is the ability to connect ambition to execution without losing the craft in between: turning uncertainty into direction, direction into systems, and systems into deployed products. I would welcome the chance to help shape what comes next.

Sincerely,
Caleb Stauss

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DESIGN WITH ALTITUDE

Principal Product Designer · Systems Architect · Creative Technologist

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Profile

For 15+ years, I've worked at the intersection of product strategy and design engineering, from concept to launch, scale, and sunset. Strategically grounded enough to shape what gets built. Technically fluent enough to build it myself. Most design problems aren't design problems. They're structure problems: eroding logic, implicit decisions, and system failures that surface as UX friction. I find them from altitude, then come down to build the right surface. AI is a force multiplier I direct, turning ambiguity into momentum and shipping systems designed for scale. You can't claim perspective if you never ascend.

Professional experience

Principal Product Designer & Systems Architect

Independent Practice · Whoa.Work / Stauss IO · Consulting engagements (including concurrent full-time roles)

2011 – Present

- Led discovery, product strategy, experience architecture, and design engineering across startup and enterprise engagements; connected business goals to the logic, interfaces, and implementation required to ship.
- Major League Pickleball — Architected and developed a connected live-operations platform for scoring, standings, schedules, player/team data, and broadcast outputs across three seasons and two live drafts.
- TokenProof — Translated complex token eligibility and verification rules into connected credential, ticketing, and staff workflows for 75+ events; TokenProof was subsequently acquired by Yuga Labs.
- HostBook — Built a React/Flask guest guidebook that used GPT to generate context-aware property and local content; Walmart Endless Aisles — designed and tested interaction patterns for a 60-inch in-store retail kiosk.

User Experience Lead

Heartland Whole Health Institute · Bentonville, AR

Sep 2020 – Oct 2022

- Established the organization’s product UX direction as its first product design hire, partnering with executive leadership on standards, prioritization, and cross-team decisions.
- Designed and implemented digital experiences, operational tools, and a reusable course platform; created shared components to align product delivery with brand and business requirements.

Professional experience · continued

Senior Product Designer, Design Systems

NerdWallet · Contract · Remote

Apr 2020 – Sep 2020

- Helped architect Currency, a unified design system spanning consumer, editorial, and SaaS products; connected Figma libraries, contribution practices, documentation, and Storybook guidance.
- Introduced variants-first component documentation that reduced discovery time 50%, tripled documentation visits, and achieved 80% satisfaction across designers and engineers.

Senior Product Designer

RevUnit · Bentonville, AR

Dec 2018 – Mar 2020

- Facilitated discovery and design sprints with business leaders, domain experts, and end users to define product direction, surface operating constraints, and scope viable MVPs.
- Turned research and stakeholder priorities into journey maps, interaction models, and functional prototypes to validate critical workflows before implementation.
- Contributed to the first product launched by Walmart International's StudioX design studio.

Senior Product Designer

RichContext · Rogers, AR

Jun 2017 – Dec 2018

- Owned end-to-end product design for Lucy, an enterprise publishing platform serving major CPG brands; architected configurable workflows across brand, client, and administrative portals.
- Established reusable catalog, content, analytics, and publishing patterns across retail channels; prototyped complex behaviors to align product, client, and engineering decisions.

Founder & Product Director

Made With Craft · Fayetteville, AR

Nov 2016 – Aug 2017

- Founded and directed a small product studio, leading discovery, product definition, design direction, delivery, client relationships, and contractor coordination.
- Converted early concepts into practical MVP roadmaps, reusable interface foundations, and launched products while balancing time, budget, and implementation realities.

Senior Product Designer

RevUnit · Bentonville, AR

Aug 2015 – Aug 2016

- Designed associate-facing tools for Walmart operations, inventory, and workforce workflows; tested solutions in active stores to validate real-world constraints.
- Built a Sketch-to-Ionic prototyping plugin to test mobile interactions and accelerate design-to-engineering feedback before native Sketch prototyping was available.

Professional experience · continued

UX/UI Designer & Developer

BlkBoxLabs · Fayetteville, AR

Nov 2014 – Jul 2015

- Established reusable UX/UI practices and improved collaboration between designers and engineers through prototypes and shared interface patterns.
- Designed insurance workflows covering quotes, account administration, payments, and reporting dashboards, alongside consumer-insights products for CPG clients.

UX/UI Designer & Front-End Developer

Summit Projects · Hood River, OR & Dallas, TX

Feb 2011 – Nov 2014

- Designed and built digital commerce, content, and brand experiences for retail and consumer clients, including Vega and Nike sub-brands.
- Bridged interaction design and front-end implementation, developing reusable interface and publishing systems rather than isolated screens.

Design with altitude

High altitude: Business context, product vision, risk, trust, and decisions that determine what should exist.

Mid altitude: Workflows, information and data architecture, design systems, reusable primitives, and the rules connecting them.

Ground level: Research validation, functional prototypes, design engineering, operational details, and shipped experiences.

Perspective shapes structure. Structure enables execution.

Core capabilities

Product strategy & leadership: Product vision and discovery · 0 → 1 development and enterprise modernization · product architecture and roadmaps · stakeholder alignment · cross-functional leadership · feasibility and tradeoff analysis

UX research & experience architecture: User research and usability testing · journey maps and user flows · wireframes and prototypes · information architecture · interaction and service design · enterprise workflows · WCAG accessibility

Design systems & scale: System strategy and governance · scalable components and design tokens · Figma libraries and Storybook · design-to-code alignment · reusable interaction patterns · documentation and adoption

Design engineering & architecture: Component-driven and full-stack prototyping · React, TypeScript, JavaScript and Python · API integrations · structured content and headless CMS architecture · Git/GitHub · implementation

Applied AI & creative technology: LLM and OpenAI API integrations · AI agents and agentic workflows · MCP · human–AI interaction design · prompt/context engineering · orchestration and AI-assisted development · Claude Code, Cursor, Codex and Gemini